# CONCEPT NOTE

## Strategic Pathways

**Where Global Skills Come Full Circle**

## 1. Background and Problem Statement

Each year, thousands of Kenyans study and work abroad, gaining advanced education, global exposure, and professional experience. However, upon returning home or seeking to contribute from the diaspora, many encounter fragmented networks, limited structured collaboration pathways, and underutilisation of their skills. As a result, valuable global expertise remains disconnected from local economic and development opportunities.

At the same time, county governments, NGOs, SMEs, and development partners face persistent challenges in accessing reliable, execution-ready talent capable of delivering high-quality projects and building sustainable ventures. Youth unemployment remains high, SME growth is constrained, and institutional capacity gaps persist.

This disconnect between globally trained talent and locally grounded opportunities reinforces patterns of brain drain rather than enabling sustainable brain circulation.

There is a clear need for structured infrastructure that mobilises global skills into coordinated, impact-driven economic activity.

## 2. The Proposed Solution

Strategic Pathways is a Kenya-based digital-enabled platform designed to mobilise study-abroad returnees and diaspora professionals into collaborative projects, consultancy engagements, and venture-building initiatives that strengthen local economies.

Rather than functioning as a job board or informal network, Strategic Pathways operates as a **talent execution and venture-building platform**. It curates skilled professionals, assembles cross-functional teams, and deploys them into income-generating and development-aligned opportunities.

The platform combines:

- Digital onboarding and profile management
- Structured team assembly
- Project and consultancy coordination
- Venture incubation support
- Institutional partnerships with counties, universities, NGOs, and donors

Through this model, Strategic Pathways transforms global exposure into measurable local impact.

# 3. Project Goal

To establish a scalable platform that converts globally acquired skills into structured local economic opportunities, strengthening workforce participation, enterprise development, and institutional capacity in Kenya.

# 4. Specific Objectives (Phase 1 – 12 Months)

1. Develop and launch a functional MVP digital platform.
2. Onboard at least 500 globally trained and locally skilled professionals.
3. Establish partnerships with 5–7 institutions (universities, counties, NGOs).
4. Deliver 5–8 pilot projects or consultancy engagements.
5. Create at least 50 short-term or project-based income opportunities.

# 5. Target Beneficiaries

### Primary Beneficiaries

- Study-abroad returnees
- Diaspora professionals seeking structured engagement

### Secondary Beneficiaries

- County governments
- Universities and alumni networks
- NGOs and development agencies
- SMEs and emerging ventures

### Indirect Beneficiaries

- Youth and communities benefiting from improved economic activity
- Local enterprises gaining access to skilled teams

# 6. Key Activities (Phase 1)

- Platform design and development (MVP launch)
- Community mobilisation and onboarding campaigns
- County and institutional partnership engagement
- Pilot programme design and implementation
- Monitoring, evaluation, and impact tracking system development

# 7. Expected Results

### Short-Term Results

- Increased engagement of globally trained professionals in local initiatives
- Structured collaboration pathways established

- Improved access to skilled execution teams for institutions

### Medium-Term Results

- Job and income creation through project-based work
- Launch of new ventures supported by cross-functional teams
- Strengthened county-level economic initiatives

### Long-Term Impact

- Transition from brain drain to brain circulation
- Stronger human capital utilisation
- Sustainable local economic growth driven by globally informed expertise

## 8. Sustainability Strategy

Strategic Pathways operates under a blended revenue model, including:

- Individual subscription fees
- Project and consultancy management fees
- Institutional partnership agreements
- Venture participation and equity (long-term)
- Catalytic grants for early-stage pilots

Over time, earned revenue will reduce reliance on grant funding, ensuring long-term sustainability.

## 9. Implementation Period

Initial Phase: 12 months (Pilot and validation phase)
Long-Term Vision: Scalable expansion across counties and regional markets within 3 years.

## 10. Alignment with Development Priorities

Strategic Pathways aligns with:

- Youth employment and entrepreneurship promotion
- Diaspora engagement strategies
- SME development and innovation ecosystems
- Local capacity building and decentralised development
- Sustainable economic growth objectives

## 11. Funding Request (Indicative)

Funding is sought to support:

- Platform development and maintenance
- Community mobilisation and outreach

- Pilot project implementation
- Monitoring and evaluation
- Core coordination and operational costs

# Conclusion

Strategic Pathways offers a structured and scalable response to the growing disconnect between global skills acquisition and local economic utilisation. By creating infrastructure that mobilises globally trained professionals into coordinated projects and ventures, the initiative contributes to sustainable economic growth, institutional strengthening, and inclusive development.

Strategic Pathways ensures that global skills do not remain abroad or unused, they come full circle.